



## COMPUTER INFORMATION SYSTEMS

COLORADO STATE UNIVERSITY

### Academic Integrity Policy

Students enrolled in Computer Information Systems courses are required to complete their assigned academic work (i.e., exercises, assignments, projects, presentations, quizzes, tests, exams) in a professional manner that is consistent with a) Colorado State University's Academic Integrity Policy as outlined in the General Catalog (the Appendix herein has excerpts), the Graduate Bulletin, and the Student Conduct Code as published by the offices of Conflict Resolution and Student Conduct Services (CRSCS), and b) the course instructor's rules and guidelines. It is the student's responsibility to know and understand these policies, rules and codes, and to seek clarification as needed. Ignorance or a misunderstanding of these policies, rules and codes is not a valid excuse for engaging in academic misconduct.

The specific rules on what constitutes misconduct when completing assigned academic work may differ by instructor, course and assignment. But in general, the following actions or behaviors are prohibited:

- Plagiarizing or copying someone else's work and submitting it as your own. For example, copying segments of code (or material for a paper), verbatim, without attribution, is not acceptable. However, searching to discover how a command, function/method or class performs while completing an assigned homework will typically be OK. **Note:** If it is permitted by the instructor, you may use code (or other materials) that are not your own, provided you clearly acknowledge the source and include a citation for it.
- Unless permitted by the instructor (e.g. the instructor suggests starting your work from an "ideal" example), gaining access to someone else's work.
- Unless permitted by the instructor (e.g. the instructor encourages you to share), making your work or someone else's work available to others
- Hiring or asking someone else to do the work for you or help you complete the work

**Note:** It is not necessarily academic misconduct to collaborate with fellow students when completing assigned work; especially, if such collaboration is encouraged by the instructor. However, misrepresenting your degree of learning or your level of knowledge by presenting some else's work as your own is academic misconduct.

If an instructor suspects misconduct and interviews the student, evidence of misconduct can include the inability of a student to explain or demonstrate understanding or comprehension of the work they have submitted as their own. The decision that academic misconduct has occurred is based on a preponderance of evidence; the standard of "more likely than not."

If academic misconduct is deemed to have occurred, the course instructor **will** assign a penalty. For the first offence, the penalty will typically be one of the following:

- Zero or negative credit for the assigned work
- Zero or negative credit for the assigned work **and** a reduction in the final letter grade
- Final letter grade of F

In addition, the student will likely face the following consequences:

- Non-renewal of stipend if the student is a Graduate Assistant in the CIS department
- Denial of future employment as a Graduate Assistant in the CIS department
- Denial of positive recommendations or references for either a job or graduate school from any member of the CIS department
- On a need-to-know basis, members of the CIS department will be informed of the academic misconduct
- Denial of any current or future request for Curricular Practical Training (CPT)

In case of repeat (in the same or other courses) or flagrant violations, the course instructor will enforce an "F" for the course, and request the University impose additional penalties such as:

- The placement of an Academic Misconduct notation in the student's official transcript
- Suspension or expulsion from the University

**Important Note:** All academic misconduct incidents will be documented and reported to CRSCS for further evaluation

**Appendix – Excerpts from CSU 2017-2018 General Catalog Academic Integrity Policy are below, with examples.**  
Click here for policy: <http://catalog.colostate.edu/general-catalog/policies/students-responsibilities/#academic-integrity>

The foundation of a university is truth and knowledge, each of which relies in a fundamental manner upon academic integrity and is diminished significantly by academic misconduct. Academic integrity is conceptualized as doing and taking credit for one's own work. A pervasive attitude promoting academic integrity enhances the sense of community and adds value to the educational process. All within the University are affected by the cooperative commitment to academic integrity.

Academic misconduct (see examples below) undermines the educational experience at Colorado State University, lowers morale by engendering a skeptical attitude about the quality of education, and negatively affects the relationship between students and faculty/instructors. Faculty/Instructors are expected to use reasonably practical means of preventing and detecting academic misconduct. Any student found responsible for having engaged in academic misconduct will be subject to academic penalty and/or University disciplinary action.

Students are encouraged to positively impact the academic integrity culture of the University by reporting incidents of academic misconduct.

Examples of academic misconduct include (but are not limited to):

1. *Cheating* – Cheating includes using unauthorized sources of information and providing or receiving unauthorized assistance on any form of academic work or engaging in any behavior specifically prohibited by the instructor in the course syllabus or class presentation. Examples include copying the work of another student on an exam, problem set, or quiz; taking an exam or completing homework for another student; possessing unauthorized notes, study sheets, answer codes, programmed calculators, or other materials during an exam; and falsifying exams or other graded paper results.
2. *Plagiarism* – Plagiarism includes the copying of language, structure, images, ideas, or thoughts of another, and representing them as one's own without proper acknowledgment and is related only to work submitted for credit; the failure to cite sources properly; sources must always be appropriately referenced, whether the source is printed, electronic or spoken. Examples include a submission of purchased research papers as one's own work; paraphrasing and/or quoting material without properly documenting the source.
3. *Unauthorized Possession or Disposition of Academic Materials* – Unauthorized possession or disposition of academic materials includes the unauthorized selling or purchasing of examinations, term papers, or other academic work; stealing another student's work; using information from or possessing exams that an instructor did not authorize for release to students.
4. *Falsification* – Falsification encompasses any untruth, either verbal or written, in one's academic work. Examples include receiving unauthorized assistance or working as a group on a take-home exam, independent exam, or other academic work without authorization, or lying to avoid taking an exam or turning in other academic work. Furthermore, falsification of any University document is a violation of academic integrity. Examples include student identification numbers, transcripts, grade sheets, credentials, University status, or letters of recommendation. Forging a signature is another specific example of falsification.
5. *Facilitation of any act of Academic Misconduct* – Facilitation of any act of academic misconduct includes knowingly assisting another to commit an act of misconduct. (Academic Integrity policies appear in the Students' Responsibilities section of the General Catalog, the Graduate and Professional Bulletin, the Faculty and Administrative Professional Manual, or the Honor Code of the Professional Veterinary School and the School of Public Health as applicable.) Examples include knowingly discussing specifics of the content of a test or examination you have taken with another student who has not yet taken that test or examination or facilitating, by sharing one's own work, a student's efforts to cheat on an exam or other academic work.